MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia – Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student number [ ]

Word count. Question One 692, Question Two 1058 (headings and body text, excluding figures, notes, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,750

Question One – Evaluating “Mat to Moment”

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Against our four objectives, I believe Mat to Moment would lift store awareness (O3) but is least likely to achieve perceived worth (O1), the objective we ranked first (Appendix A). Our objectives were a strength, being specific, measurable and linked to challenges we identified (Colley, 1961).

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A is still the right audience, as its members treat activewear as part of their identity (Belk, 1988). However, these women are also under financial pressure, with over half of their generation delaying major decisions (Deloitte, 2026), a tension we never resolved. At A$100–200 per item, Alo is “masstige” rather than luxury, and new-luxury buyers spend more on categories they value while cutting back on others (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We followed Kapferer and Bastien’s (2009) rule that luxury needs meaning instead of justification, but I now see that stretched buyers need justification, as guilt suppresses indulgent purchases unless the expense feels worthwhile (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

Our line, "From Mat to Moment", is clear, and its calm after-class moments differs from rivals' focus on sweat, a sign of divergent, creative advertising (Smith & Yang, 2004). However, activewear worn from class to the rest of the day is simply what athleisure means (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and our own report notes that P.E Nation sells leggings the same way (P.E Nation, n.d.). Because any rival

could run our line, viewers may credit the ad to a better-known brand, risking our 60% brand-attribution target.

Our price argument is also weak. Most people see only bus panels and Instagram posts, where Worth it appears as an “instructor-tested” label. That label is a peripheral cue, a quick signal of quality rather than an argument (Petty et al., 1983), and it never explains why Alo costs A$100–200. The full case appears only on product pages, in stores and at 36 sessions reaching a few hundred. Attitudes formed from cues are weaker and fade faster (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986), so O1 depends on the channels reaching the fewest people.

1.4 Channel Selection

Our channel split weakens reach. Outdoor, at A$55,000 (22%), is our largest cost, but it has low audience selectivity (Belch & Belch, 2021). A bus panel is seen by everyone on its route, so much of that money misses our segment. Instagram and TikTok would spend it more precisely, as their ads reach 69% and 51% of Australian adults, and 25–34-year-olds are Instagram’s largest user group (Kemp, 2026; NapoleonCat, 2025).

1.5 Integration

Integration is our plan’s main strength. Every touchpoint carries the same line, set and sign-off, and only the hook and call to action change, giving consistent meaning without identical executions (Batra & Keller, 2016). However, the order of our messages is inconsistent. Our objectives follow Vaughn’s (1980) feel–learn–do order, in which people form a feeling about a fashion brand before weighing up facts. Yet our journey follows AIDA, which starts with attention and saves the price argument for the Desire stage in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). So most people would learn where our stores are but never why Alo is worth the money.

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

I expect O3 to succeed, as one fact repeated near stores suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983). O2 is plausible, as localising Alo through Sydney sources was one of our best decisions, since perceived localness adds relational value even for global brands (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 is at risk, and O4 depends on it, as people act only after forming an attitude (Vaughn, 1980). Post-testing

would also struggle, as only paid social, 21% of spend, has randomised holdouts, while the rest relies on before-and-after change, which can overstate advertising effects (Gordon et al., 2019).

1.7 What I Would Change

Therefore, while keeping what worked, I would argue Alo's price openly in the media most people see, replace "From Mat to Moment" with an idea only Alo could own, and move money from outdoor and sessions into Instagram and TikTok, where holdout tests can measure results. Question Two develops these changes.

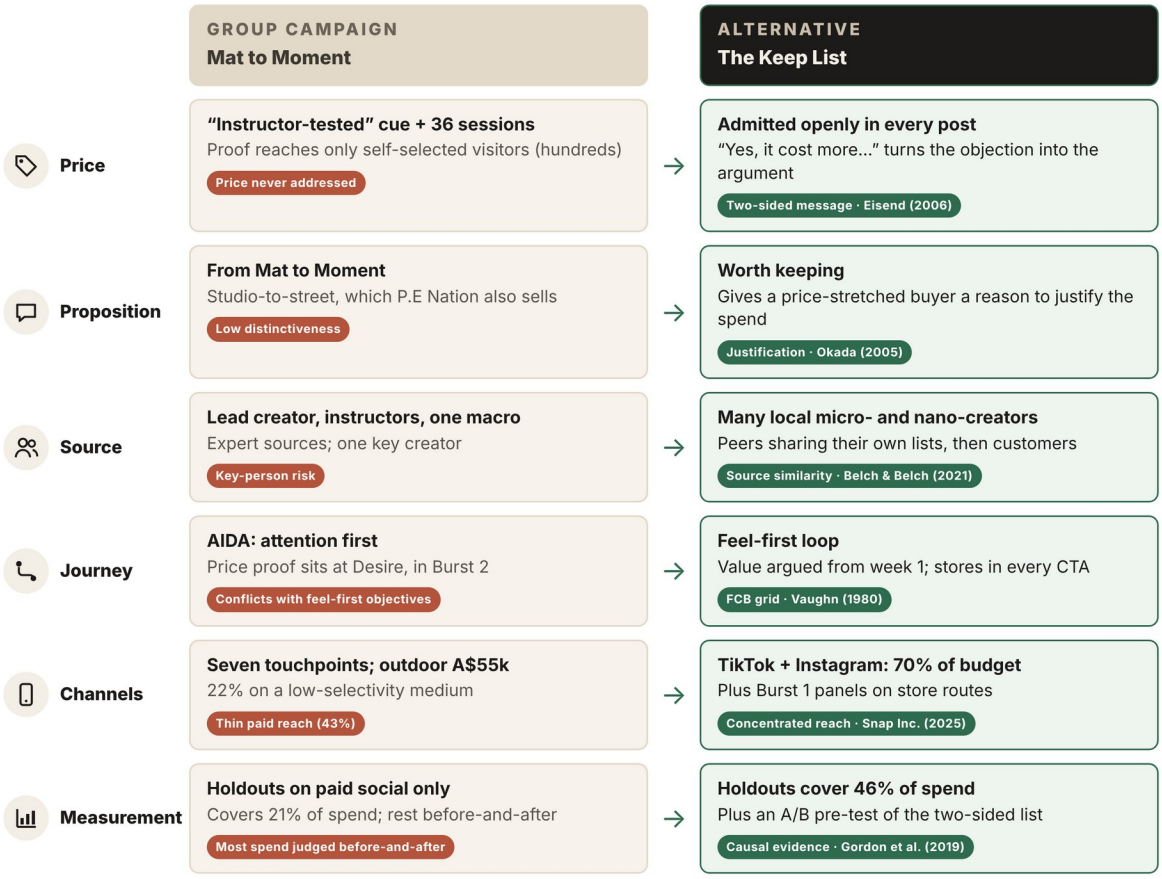
Question Two – An Alternative Approach, "The Keep List"

2.1 What I Changed and Why

The Keep List keeps what Question One found effective, namely Segment A, objectives O1–O4, Sydney sources and consistent brand codes, and changes only what it found weak (Figure 1). Price was our biggest unresolved problem, so perceived worth (O1) becomes the lead objective.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses come from Question One, and tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

I keep Segment A because its identity-driven buying still fits Alo best (Belk, 1988), and the price tension from Question One is a message problem, not an audience problem. The insight changes. In 2024, "loud budgeting", openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice (Axios, 2024). Therefore, Financially pressured young women are cutting back out loud, and what they keep says who they are. Alo's positioning as premium all-day activewear stays, now expressed as "worth keeping" instead of "studio to street".

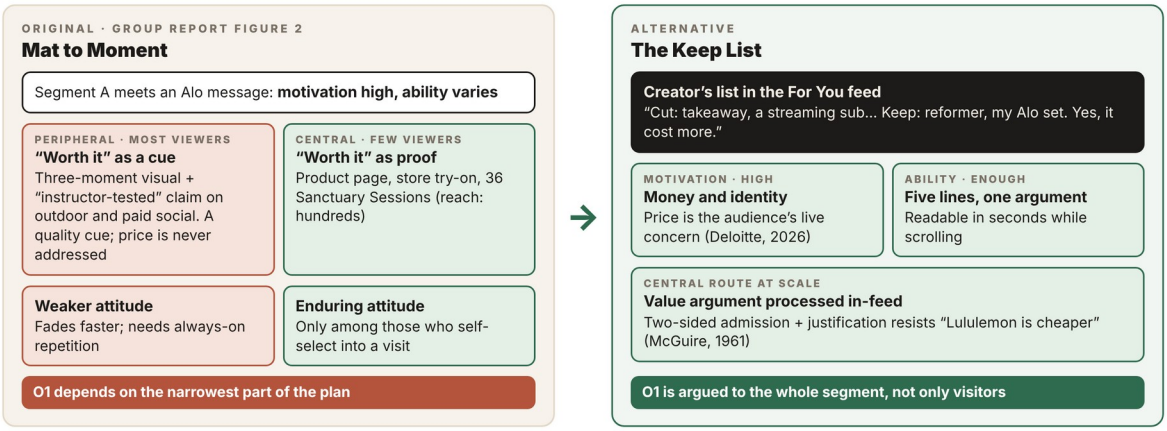
2.3 Message, Persuasion Route and Sources

Our original message praised quality without mentioning price. Mine is two-sided, as creators admit Alo costs more, then explain why it is worth keeping. Admitting a drawback makes a source more credible (Eisend, 2006), and raising the price objection first weakens later counter-arguments such as “Lululemon is cheaper” (McGuire, 1961). The list also supplies the justification our campaign lacked (Okada, 2005). Under mental accounting, consumers assign spending to separate budgets (Thaler, 1999), so placing Alo beside cancelled takeaway moves it from a “fashion splurge” into “things I use every day” (Appendix B). Because peers, not Alo, discuss price and nothing is discounted, Alo’s prestige is protected (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009).

Under the Elaboration Likelihood Model, people take the central route and weigh an argument carefully only when they are motivated and able to (Petty et al., 1983). In our plan, that careful thinking about price required visiting a product page, store or session (Figure 2). Price already motivates this audience, and a five-line list gives them the ability, as it is read in seconds yet makes one clear argument. Thus, the case for O1 reaches everyone who sees the ad, not only those who visit.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report’s Figure 2.

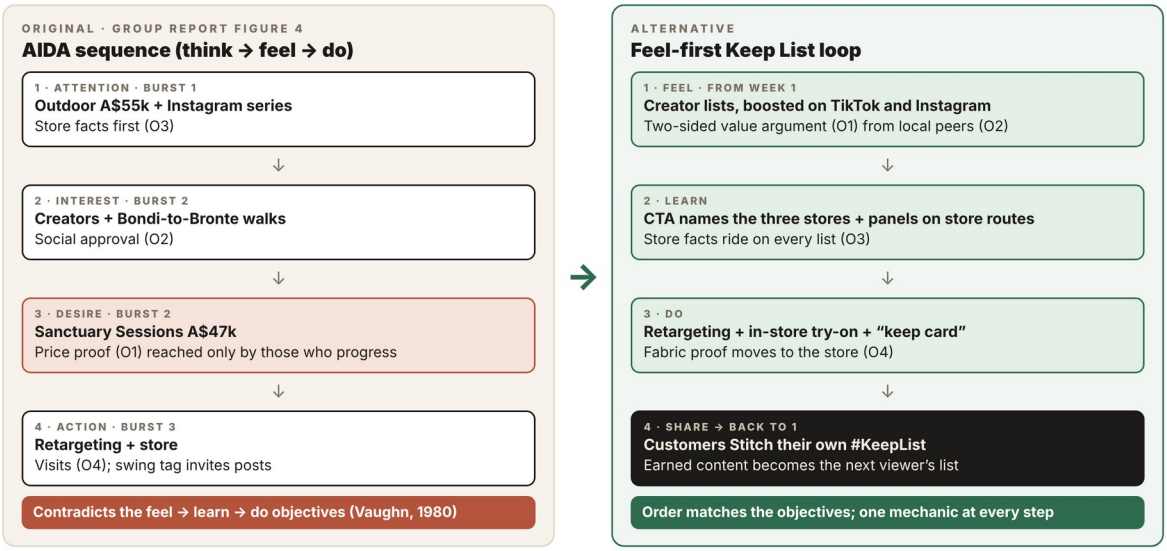
Lists come from many Sydney micro- and nano-creators, then customers, whose similarity to the audience builds trust (Belch & Belch, 2021; Campbell & Farrell, 2020). The shared format becomes a distinctive brand asset linked to Alo (Sharp, 2010).

2.4 Journey

Figure 3 replaces our AIDA journey with Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do order, reordering bursts to match (Appendix C). Each list first builds feeling (O1, O2), then ends with the three store names, so viewers learn where to buy (O3). Retargeting and in-store try-ons turn interest into visits (O4). Customers use TikTok's Stitch feature to reply with their own lists, and each becomes the next viewer's starting point, closing the advocacy loop (Court et al., 2009). Boosted and reshared, the same posts work as paid, owned and earned media (Stephen & Galak, 2012), saving budget and keeping one message.

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report's Figure 4.

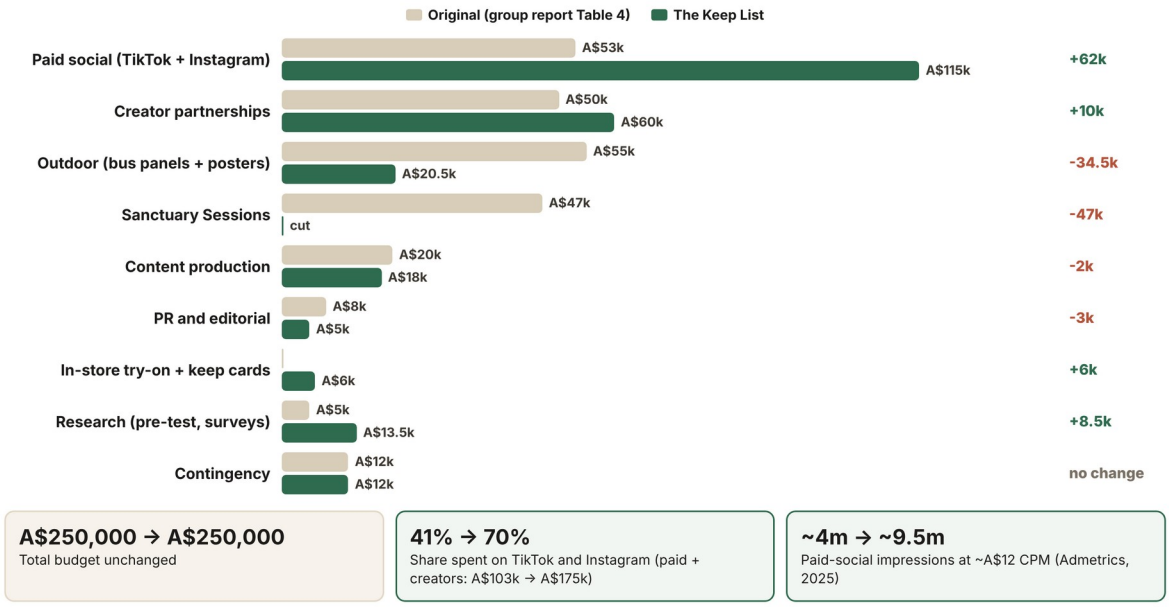
2.5 Channels and Budget

Within the same A$250,000 (Figure 4), I cut Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000), which reached only a few hundred people, accepting less hands-on proof, and reduce outdoor from A$55,000 to

A$20,500 for Burst 1 panels on store routes. TikTok and Instagram rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, 70% of the budget. At about A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 of paid social buys roughly 9.5 million impressions, over double our original four million, mirroring Ben & Jerry's single-platform success (Snap Inc., 2025). I would pre-test the list against a one-sided version (Belch & Belch, 2021), and holdouts would cover 46% of spend, not 21% (Gordon et al., 2019; Appendix D).

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000

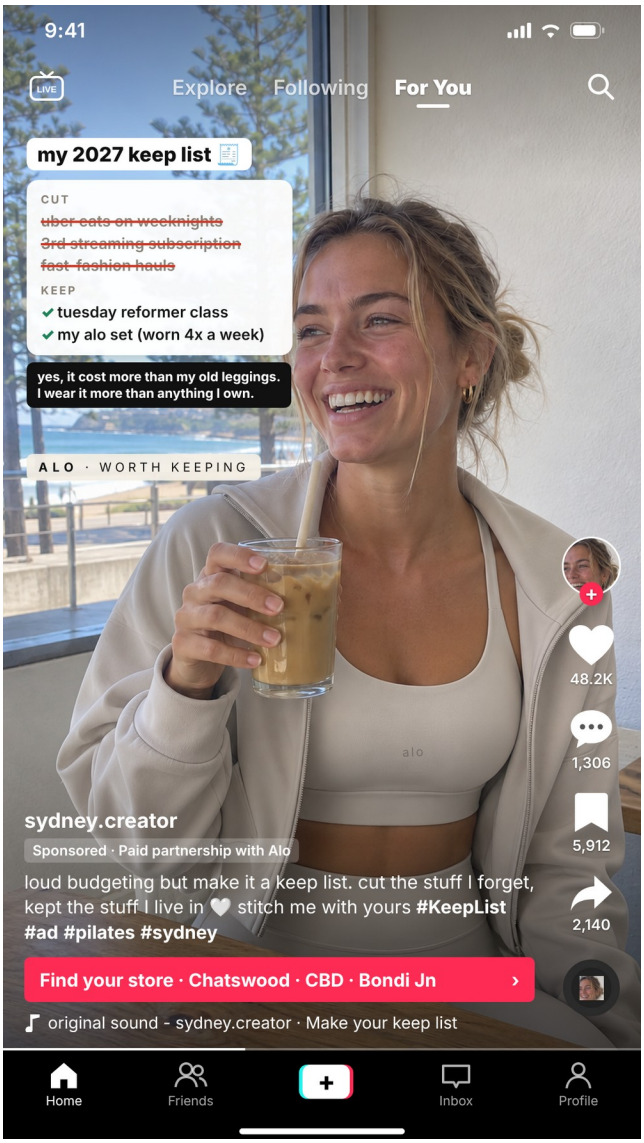


Note. Original figures are from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels cover 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators cover about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame. The person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used], using the prompt “Photorealistic vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral ‘bone’ colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight

grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic), using the prompt "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 opens a 15-second TikTok Spark Ad, where the list builds line by line beneath the creator's voice-over. As a Spark Ad boosts her own post, it keeps her handle and comments (TikTok for Business, n.d.-a), reading as peer content, not an ad.

Message. The lowercase headline "my 2027 keep list" reads like a personal note and states the proposition within three seconds, as TikTok advises (TikTok for Business, n.d.-b). The list is the argument, three things cut and two kept, then the admission "yes, it cost more than my old leggings". The sign-off "Alo. Worth keeping." attaches the justification to the brand. It persuades because it borrows the loud-budgeting format this audience uses (Axios, 2024), so the price case reads as a peer's reasoning, not a sales claim.

Imagery. A woman in her mid-twenties laughs over an iced latte in a beachside Sydney café after class in the matching set. Natural light, unretouched skin and a handheld look suit Gen Z's preference for authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018), making the endorsement believable. This shows the set working beyond class, and the beach and Norfolk pines signal a local creator, supporting O2 (Sichtmann et al., 2019).

Design. Native TikTok text makes the post read as creator content, while red strikethroughs and green ticks make trade-offs quick to read, and Alo's neutral palette, wordmark and sticker preserve brand linkage. "Sponsored · Paid partnership" sits under the handle and #ad in the caption, because advertising must be clearly distinguishable, especially in native formats (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021; Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action and engagement. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction (O3, O4), while the caption invites viewers to Stitch their own list. Each reply carries the message into peers' feeds.

AI limitations. My AI-generated photograph is believable but too polished for phone footage, and audiences often find artificial personas uncanny and “authentically fake” (Lou et al., 2023). It cannot reproduce Alo’s garments or logo, and its single slim model cannot show our segment’s range of bodies, weakening relevance. Real creators must wear real Alo and list genuine trade-offs, as scripted personal claims would mislead (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

Compared with our plan, The Keep List argues price more widely, owns its idea and doubles paid reach. Its main limitation is ethical, as financial hardship is a recognised source of consumer vulnerability (Australian Competition and Consumer Commission [ACCC], 2021), and manipulation undermines normal decision-making (Sher, 2011), so lists must celebrate what people cut, never presenting the set as a necessity. Overall, I expect stronger O1 and O2, similar O3, and store-dependent O4 results.

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Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

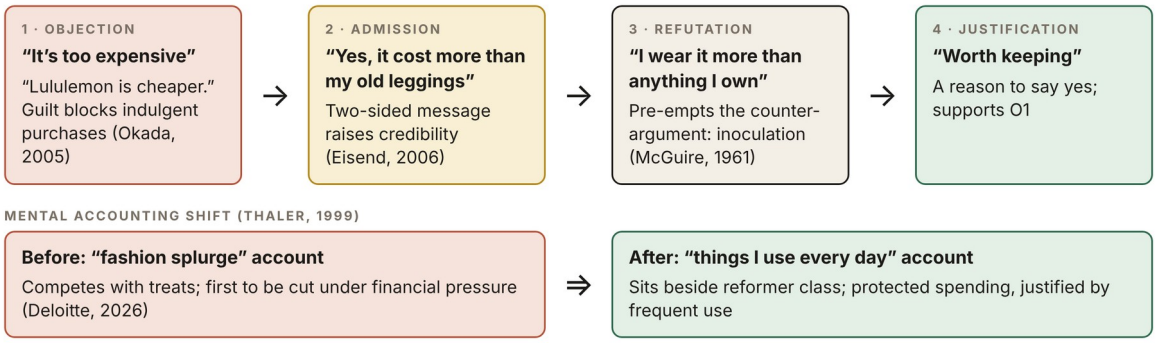
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019); target sits near the ~5-point survey limit	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never addresses price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. My evaluation, supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

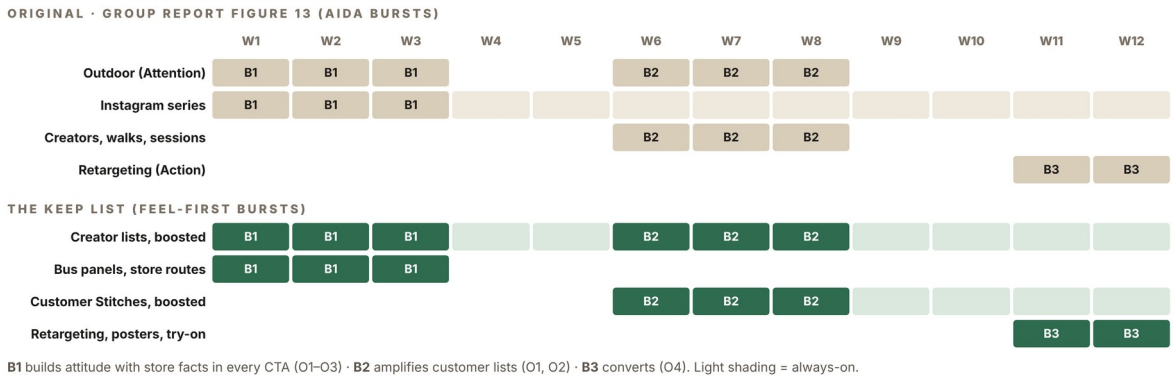


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After



Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13, with pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).